A FEATURE FILM

RHYTHM & BLOOMS

One night can keep a neighborhood singing.

Written by Kelly R. Tenney

NCCA ENTERTAINMENT

AUBURN AVENUE -- ATLANTA, GEORGIA

"Every place has its own mus
You just have to know how to

-- ELLIE CRUZ

Six weeks to save the Blue Note

ELLIE CRUZ has held the Blue Note Lounge together through debt and grief for three years. When Meridian Development files a safety objection threatening her operating license, Ellie announces her late father's cancelled festival on Auburn Avenue with six weeks and almost no money.

MILES BRADFORD, a precise landscape architect rebuilding from his own collapse, signs on to design the rooftop garden. He comes for the project. He stays for something harder to name.

THE BLUE NOTE

A lived-in jazz room where open mic n
history, and the next generation share

THE ROOFTOP

Miles's garden begins as a festival ce
becomes a visible promise that the blo

THE LEAD

ELLIE CRUZ

Early 40s -- The keeper becomes the artist

Ellie has held the Blue Note together through grief, debt, and slow displacement for three years. She knows how to fight for her father's room. She has avoided finishing the music he left behind.

HER CHOICE

Move the festival indoors when the rooftop closes. Let the song be heard even when the lights go out. Not because she has to. Because it is the right version.

"She had the note
without know
She'd been ca
her father's
the whole ti

RHYTHM AND BL

THE PARTNERSHIP

MILES BRADFORD

Early 40s -- A precise architect finds room for improvisation

After a professional collapse, Miles signs on to design the rooftop garden. His plans face safety rules, scarce money, and a community that needs proof before it gives trust. He comes with blueprints. He leaves having built something that cannot be drawn.

THE DYNAMIC

Ellie gives Miles a reason to build again. Miles helps Ellie make the festival possible without taking her voice. Two adults who have each stopped trusting their own instincts, working on the same block, building toward the same night.

*"That was the
I understood what
about feel
like a son*

-- MILES BRADF

THE PRESSURE

The clock keeps tightening

WEEK ONE

SIX WEEKS

Ellie announces the festival publicly on Auburn Street with no budget and a threatened operating lease.

MID-POINT

THE REVIEW

Structural certification, compliance hearings, and a city board put the Blue Note under scrutiny.

THREE DAYS OUT

THREE DAYS

The rooftop is restricted. Ellie declares the indoor acoustic festival the right version.

THE NIGHT

OPENING

A neighborhood blackout. The song plays in the dark.

A neighborhood with a stake in the outcome

VICTOR LANGSTON

50s

A developer with a sincere buyout offer and a personal tie to the Blue Note's history. His arc ends not with villainy but with a different choice than he planned.

MS. ODESSA

80s

The neighborhood's living memory. Eight decades on this block. At the festival, her cane keeps four-beat time and the whole room follows.

DEON TAYLOR

50s

The Blue Note's bartender. Seen everything. Tells Ellie the plain truth when no one else will. His big scene is staying when others leave.

YARA AND CAM

20s / 40s

Yara tests Ellie's trust and earns something harder than approval. Cam draws the crowd together at the moment the story needs it most.

When the power dies, the music stays.

The festival moves indoors, acoustic, no amplification. Battery lanterns warm the corners. Then the neighborhood grid goes dark. The whole block loses power.

Ellie plays the unfinished song. The room carries it with her. The next morning: a twelve-month provisional extension. The victory has work attached to it.

"Play it t
lights com

ELLISON CRUZ

POSITIONING

Warm, musical, and rooted in place

OWN

Family healing, mature romance, earned community ending.

Ellie and Miles build something real on a real block. The festival is the holiday engine. The relationship is earned through actual work. The ending is hopeful without being unearned.

BET+

Black excellence embedded in conflict, setting, and solution.

Auburn Avenue is a character, not a backdrop. The institutions -- the compliance board, the preservation hearing, the jazz club -- are specific, not generic. The victory belongs to the community.

FAMILY | **ROMANCE** | **COMMUNITY**

SUGGESTED CASTING

ELLIE CRUZ

Viola Davis / Angela Bassett

MILES BRADFORD

Idris Elba / Omari Hardwick

VICTOR LANGSTON

Mahershala Ali / David Oyelowo

DEON TAYLOR

Wood Harris / Delroy Lindo

MS. ODESSA

Living legend -- 80s actress, deep screen authority

YARA

Ego Nwodim / Dominique Fishback

Casting suggestions only. No talent attachments are represented.

NCCA ENTERTAINMENT

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Some gardens take time. Some just need the right song.